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t 18 years of age, Lamine Yamal is already a Euro champion, Young Player of the Tournament at the Euros, a three-time La Liga winner, a two-time Supercopa winner and a Copa del Rey champion.

He is the bookies' joint favourite to win the Golden Ball at the 2026 FIFA World Cup. Such is the influence he wields in Luis de la Fuente's Spain side. Capable of unleashing moments of absolute brilliance with the ball while also keeping a calm head in front of goal, Yamal is arguably the best teenager in world football at the moment.

Euro 2024 gave the world a glimpse of the magic he could create. He finished as the tournament's best playmaker with four assists in seven games. He has only gotten better since. The Barcelona youngster has scored 24 goals and recorded 18 assists across all competitions in the 2025/26 season.

La Roja's possession-dominant approach left a lasting imprint on European football, but it has not yielded a similar impact for the national team since its 2010 World Cup triumph. With a new generation of pacy, direct forwards like Yamal in its arsenal, this could be the chance for the Spaniards to demonstrate their title-winning credentials.

If Yamal has a tournament to remember, it may be time to promote him from the 'best young player in the world' conversation to the 'best player in the world' dialogue.

# Lamine Yamal



## SPAIN

Age - 18

Club - Barcelona

NT Appearances - 25

Goals - 6

Assists - 12